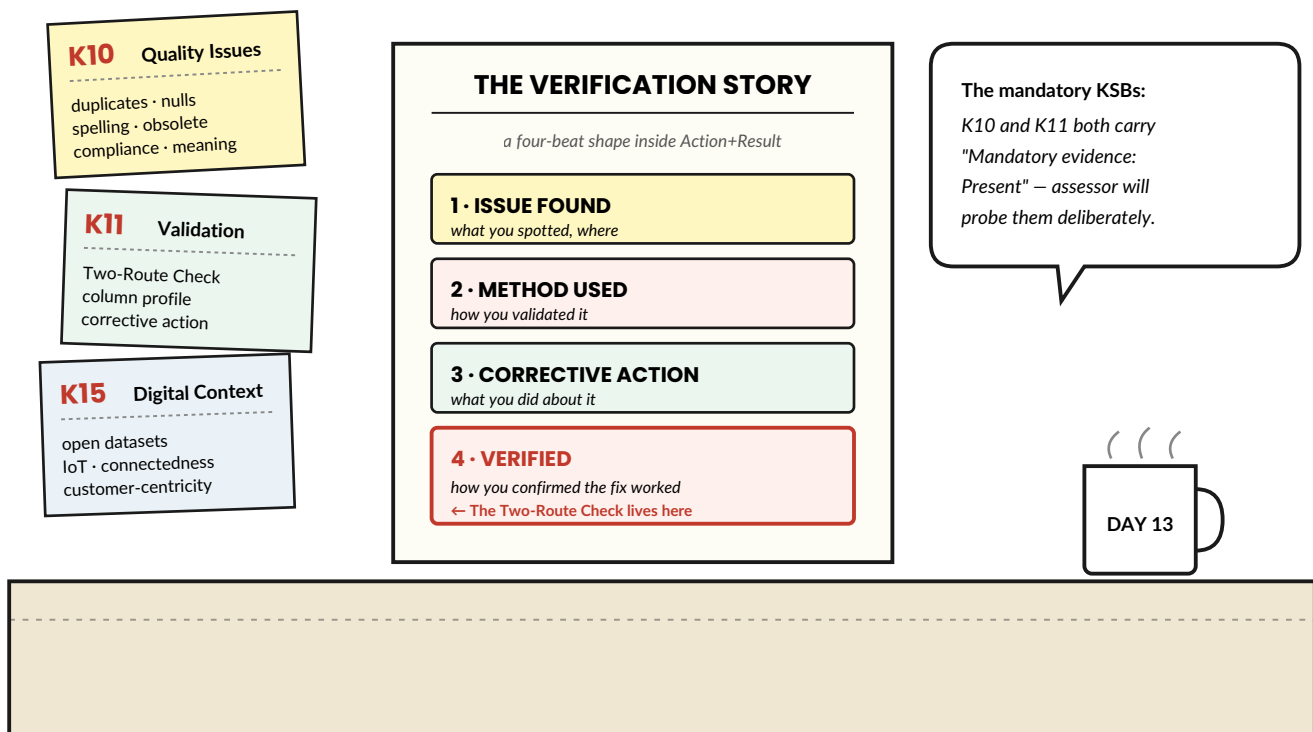


13

second content area · the verification day

Analysis & Validation, STARR-ed

K10 · K11 · K15 · and a four-beat shape that lives inside Action



K10 and K11 are mandatory-evidence KSBs — the assessor will probe them deliberately. Today's named device, **The Verification Story**, is a four-beat shape that fits inside the Action+Result layers of STARR and rehearses exactly what those KSBs ask for.

The Quality Six

K10 lists the categories of data-quality problem you should be able to name and describe from your own work. Six recurring shapes — below: one example and one detection method for each.

THE SIX DATA-QUALITY ISSUES (K10)

1 • MISCLASSIFICATION

e.g. drama tagged as documentary;
payment marked refunded when paid.

spot it with:
Group By on category column

2 • DUPLICATES

e.g. same patient on the list twice;
repeated cancellation rows.

spot it with:
Group By + COUNT > 1

3 • SPELLING / FORMAT

e.g. "MRI" vs "M.R.I." vs "M R I";
trailing whitespace.

spot it with:
column profile distinct count

4 • OBSOLETE DATA

e.g. last-refreshed 3 months ago;
cached lookup-table out of date.

spot it with:
MAX(timestamp) sanity-check

5 • COMPLIANCE

e.g. identifiable data where
aggregated should suffice (GDPR).

spot it with:
audit who needs what

6 • MEANING / TRANSLATION

e.g. "active" means different
things in two source systems.

spot it with:
read the data dictionary

KNOW ONE EXAMPLE OF EACH FROM YOUR WORK.

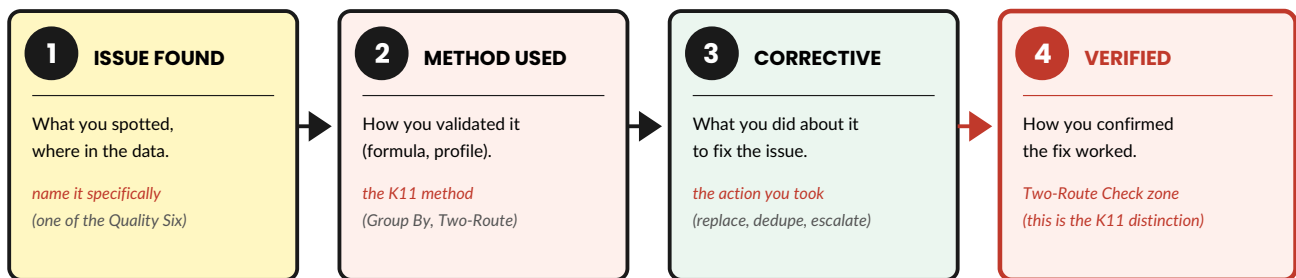
K10 is "Mandatory evidence: Present" — the assessor will probe whether you can name and discuss multiple quality issues from your real workplace, not generic textbook examples.

Two real examples covered well beats six described thinly.

The Verification Story (named device today) is how you turn each one into a STARR answer.

The Verification Story

K10 asks *what quality issue did you find?* K11 asks *how did you validate it?* The Verification Story answers both inside the same STARR — it's a four-beat shape that lives in the Action and Result layers.



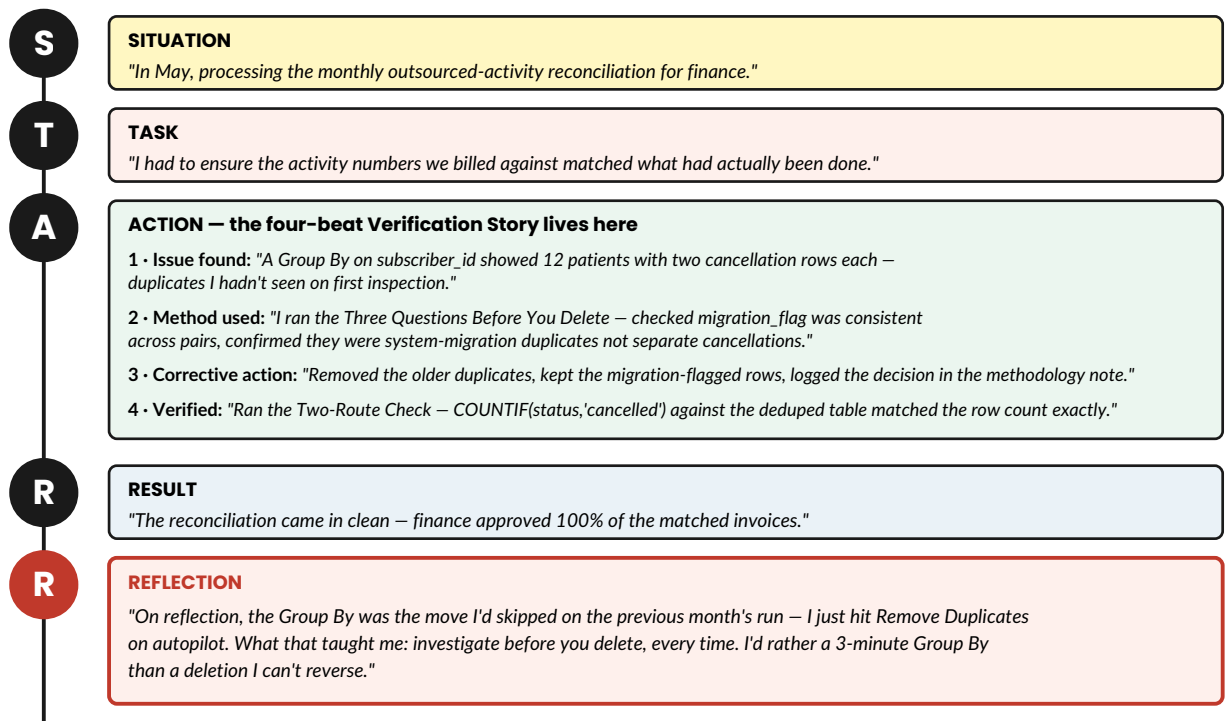
SHOW THIS OFF

Most apprentices stop at beat 3 (corrective action) and don't go on to beat 4 (verified). K11 specifically asks for the verification — *"how do you know the fix worked?"* The Two-Route Check from Phase 1 is the answer. Use those exact words: *"I verified with a Two-Route Check — route one was X, route two was Y, they matched."*

The Verification Story inside STARR

A typical K10/K11 question answered in STARR shape, with the four-beat Verification Story folded into the Action layer and the Two-Route Check in beat 4.

THE VERIFICATION STORY — in a STARR answer
 Q: "Tell me about a time you found a data quality issue and how you handled it."



Pulling Phase 1 forward

You spent four days in Phase 1 building this exact vocabulary. Today is about deploying it — in conversation rather than in Excel. Three named devices from Phase 1 are central to the Verification Story:

Validate then Verify

Validation is input quality (data fit for purpose). Verification is method correctness (output is right). Both score. They're different.

from Day 4

The Two-Route Check

Compute the same finding two different ways. Same number = verified. Different number = something to investigate.

from Day 4

Three Questions Before You Delete

Why is it here? What does it represent? What would I lose if I removed it? The Delete Anomaly is the red flag.

from Day 2

ASSESSOR FAVOURITE

Saying any of these named-device phrases out loud is a strong signal. *"I ran the Three Questions Before You Delete..."* tells the assessor you have a vocabulary for the work, not just a habit. K11 specifically rewards *"methods of validating data"* — named methods score above unnamed ones.

K15 — data in the digital world

K15 is the one most learners skim. It's lighter on technique and heavier on context — how the work fits into the wider digital landscape. Three things to be able to talk about.

1. Open data and trusted external datasets

The assessor may ask whether you've used *open datasets* (e.g. ONS statistics, NHS Digital, government open data). If you haven't directly, you'll probably have seen them used — or know where you'd reach for them. One example is enough.

2. Data underpinning digital interactions

Every login, search, click, payment, scan generates data. In a clinical context: every appointment booking, every result release. The question shape is usually *"how does data show up in the systems you work with day-to-day?"* — answer with one specific system from your workplace.

3. Customer-centricity / connectedness

Data joins up customers, applications, devices, IoT. The shape: *"how does the data you handle connect to a wider system / customer journey?"* — describe one specific workflow.



BRAIN POWER

K15 is rarely the longest question. A 30-second answer with one named open dataset and one workplace example is enough. Don't overthink it — this isn't a Distinction-graded KSB. Focus your prep time on K10 and K11.



SHARPEN YOUR PENCIL 30 minutes — the Verification Story, in your own words

Pick your analysis & validation anchor. Fill in the four beats. The fourth one is where most apprentices stop short — spend extra time there.

My analysis & validation anchor: *name it here:*

Beat 1 — *What issue did you find, where, when?*

Beat 2 — *What method did you use to validate it?*

Beat 3 — *What corrective action did you take?*

Beat 4 — *How did you VERIFY the fix worked? (the K11 distinction beat)*

Halfway House

Five quick questions.

1. K10 and K11 both carry "Mandatory evidence: Present" — expect direct probing.

☐ **True** ☐ **False**

2. The Verification Story has four beats: issue found, method used, corrective action, verified.

☐ **True** ☐ **False**

3. Naming a validation method (like "Two-Route Check") scores higher than describing it unnamed.

☐ **True** ☐ **False**

4. K15 is one of the Distinction-graded KSBs — deepest answer of the chapter belongs here.

☐ **True** ☐ **False**

5. "Verified" can be the same as "result" — both describe what happened after the fix.

☐ **True** ☐ **False**

Answers

1. **True.** Mandatory evidence means specific points must be hit — come prepared with concrete examples.

2. **True.** Issue found · Method used · Corrective action · Verified. Beat 4 is the one most candidates skip.

3. **True.** K11 specifically rewards methods, named.

4. **False.** K15 is a Pass-only KSB — one workplace example is enough. K10 and K11 are where to invest.

5. **False.** "Verified" is *how you confirmed the fix worked*. "Result" is what changed as a consequence.

There are no *Dumb* Questions

Q: My validation method was "I just looked at it carefully." Is that enough?

A: Often, yes — eyeballing is a valid method when the dataset is small. But name what you were looking for. "I scanned the column for entries that broke the five-digit pattern; row 47 was the only one." Specific = method. Vague = not method.

Q: I caught the issue but I didn't actually fix it — my manager did. What do I say?

A: Tell that story. Beat 3 becomes "I escalated to my manager because the fix required a system permission I didn't have; she made the change after agreeing the approach with me." Escalation **is** corrective action; the assessor isn't checking whether you owned every step, just whether you understood the problem and the resolution.

Q: Can the Verification Story work for a quality issue I prevented rather than found?

A: Yes — and it scores well. Beat 1 becomes "what could have gone wrong," beat 2 "the check I put in place to prevent it," beat 3 "no remediation needed because it didn't occur," beat 4 "verified the control by running [test] monthly." Prevention stories often score above remediation stories because they show you thinking ahead.

Q: I don't have a single big quality story — just lots of small ongoing checks.

A: Use one of the small ones, told in detail. Even a daily nullity check on a single column is a Verification Story if you can describe what you'd do if the nulls jumped. Specificity beats scale.

Q: What if my beat 4 (verified) doesn't really exist — we just trusted the fix worked?

A: Then say so honestly, and add a Reflection: "On reflection, I didn't have a verification step in place — what I'd do differently next time is run a Two-Route Check against the historic record to confirm." That's a Distinction-shaped answer to a Pass-shaped story.

Say it for real

Two questions to rehearse out loud. End each with a clear beat 4.

Q1 — Tell me about a time you found a data quality issue.

The shape: full STARR with the four-beat Verification Story inside Action. The verified step (beat 4) names a specific method — *"I ran a Two-Route Check by computing the same total from a different angle..."*

Try: name the Quality-Six category in beat 1 — *"a duplicate-records issue..."* or *"a misclassification issue..."*. Categorising signals K10 directly.

Q2 — What methods of validating data do you use in your role?

The shape: a short stack of three methods, with one example each. Name them: *"Two-Route Check, column profiling, Three Questions Before You Delete."* Then one specific workplace story for one of them.

SHOW THIS OFF

The phrase *"I verified by running the Two-Route Check"* is doing three things at once: claiming a method, naming it, and signalling K11. Use those exact words at least once in the discussion.

Bullet Points — the chapter in 30 seconds

- **Three KSBs.** K10 (quality issues) · K11 (validation methods) · K15 (digital context).
- **K10 and K11 are mandatory-evidence KSBs.** The assessor will probe directly — have specific examples ready.
- **The Quality Six.** Misclassification · duplicates · spelling/format · obsolete · compliance · meaning. Two real examples beat six generic ones.
- **The Verification Story** — four beats inside Action: *issue found* · *method used* · *corrective action* · *verified*.
- **Beat 4 is the one most candidates skip.** The Two-Route Check is the answer.
- **Pull Phase 1 forward.** Validate then Verify, The Two-Route Check, Three Questions Before You Delete — named devices score.
- **K15 is the light one.** One open-dataset example + one workplace system. Move on.

TEST DRIVE

Tick each only when it's true:

- ☐ You can name all six Quality issues from memory.
- ☐ You can name your one workplace example of each (or at least three of the six).
- ☐ You've drafted a full Verification Story for your analysis & validation anchor.
- ☐ You've practised saying "*I verified with a Two-Route Check*" out loud.
- ☐ You can give a 30-second K15 answer covering one open dataset and one workplace system.

COMING UP — DAY 14

Distribution & Dissemination, STARR-ed. The biggest content area — K5, K12, K13, K14, S10, S11, S12, S13. Tomorrow's named device: **The Audience Switch** — one piece of analysis, three audiences (technical peer · manager · end customer). Also sets up D2 (why-you-communicate-this-way) and D3 (storage, security, ethics).

that's Day 13 done — validation, rehearsed.